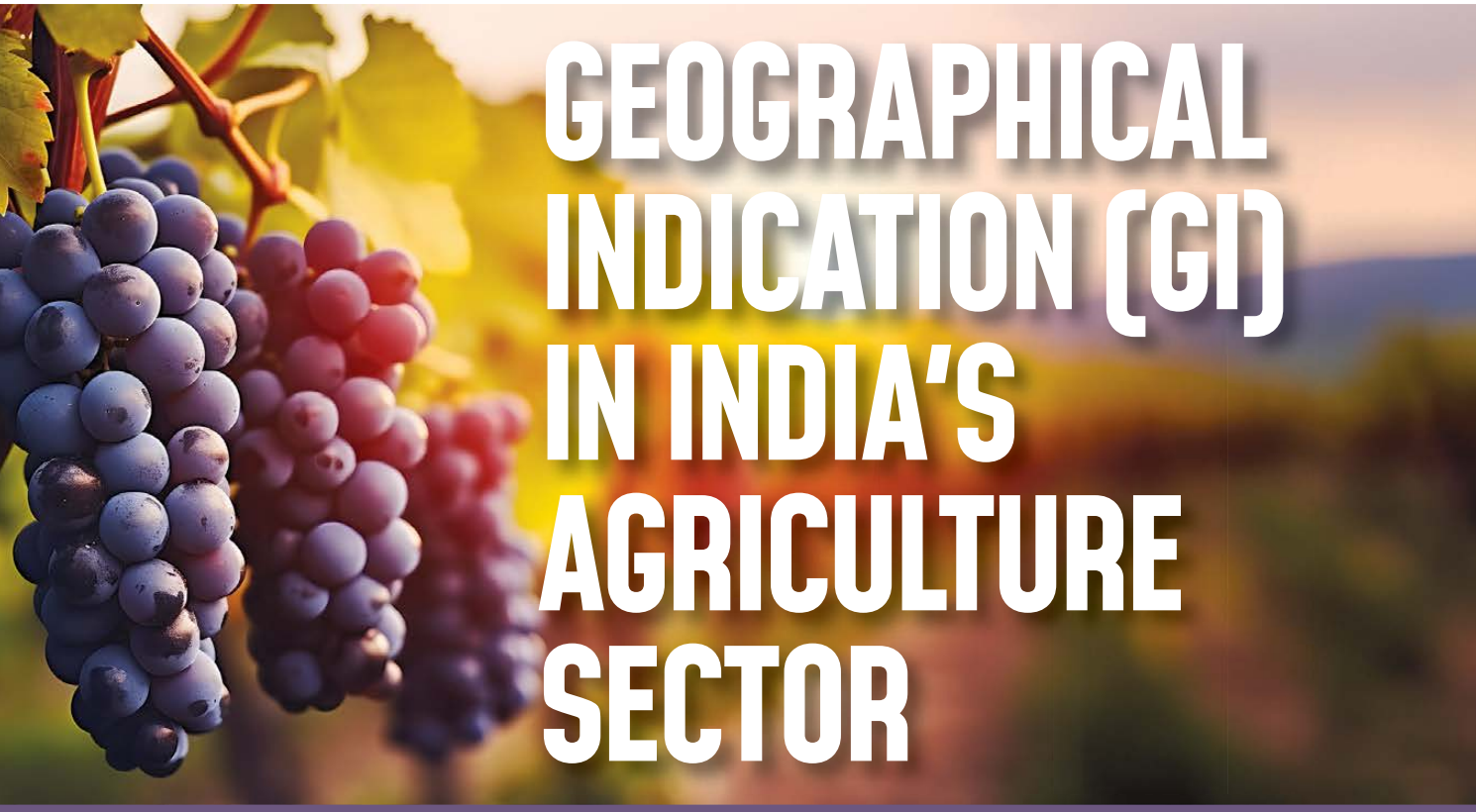


GEOGRAPHICAL INDICATION (GI) IN INDIA'S AGRICULTURE SECTOR

Safeguarding Heritage, Empowering Farmers

Geographical Indications (GIs) are symbols used on products from a specific geographical location that have **unique qualities** or a **reputation** linked to that location. They certify that the product has specific attributes, is made using traditional methods, or enjoys a certain reputation due to its origin. GIs protect the reputation and legacy of regional products while promoting economic growth in specific areas. They provide a **distinct identity** to products, and **prevent unauthorized use** of their geographical name, while maintaining the **cultural and historical identity** of products associated with specific regions.

India's rich tapestry of farmer producing traditions is evident in its diverse array of Geographical Indications (GIs) within the agricultural sector. India is making concerted efforts to protect its organically grown distinctive agricultural products across different geographies to generate higher returns. Inspired by the vision of **Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** and under the leadership of **Sh. Piyush Goyal, Hon'ble Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, Textiles**, the government has remained resolute in its endeavors to **promote and safeguard GI-tagged products**. This steadfast commitment has not only bolstered economic growth but has also played a pivotal role in preserving our rich cultural heritage while showcasing **India's unique agricultural offerings** on the global platform. In global markets driven by buyers, the development of strong Indian agricultural brands is helping our **farmers become more competitive**. Such remarkable achievements owe much to the strategic initiatives and unwavering dedication of the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

GI Tags: Empowering Farmer- Producers and Enriching Culture

India encompasses a range of agro products such as **fruits, vegetables, spices**, and more. The geographical factors, including **climate, soil,** and **traditional farming practices**, contribute to the distinctiveness of these products. From the aromatic **Basmati rice** of the Himalayan foothills to the exquisite **Darjeeling tea**, each product reflects the unique terroir of its origin, ensuring a connection between the product and the land. Acquiring a Geographical Indication (GI) tag for agricultural products offers a myriad of **advantages to farmers and communities** alike.

Firstly, GI-tagged products often fetch **higher prices in the market**, providing farmers with **improved profit margins** compared to their non-GI counterparts. Moreover, the GI designation serves as a **protective shield** against the misuse of product names and prevents the unfair exploitation of their reputation elsewhere, thereby **safeguarding the incomes** of farmers. Additionally, the **global recognition** bestowed upon GI-tagged products facilitates their wider acceptance both domestically and internationally, fostering market expansion and **increased revenues**. Furthermore, by incentivizing the **preservation of traditional cultivation methods** and **regional processing techniques**, the GI tag helps to maintain the unique characteristics and heritage associated with these products. Beyond economic benefits,